



VICTORIA DIAMONDS

The Jewellery Care Guide

Simple habits to keep every piece brilliant

THE GOLDEN RULES · YELLOW GOLD · STERLING SILVER
DIAMONDS · SETTING DIAGRAMS · WHEN TO REMOVE & SIGNS TO VISIT US

EST. IN THE CRAFT OF FINE JEWELLERY

The Golden Rules of Jewellery Care

Before the specifics of metal and stone, a handful of habits protect almost everything in your jewellery box.

- 01 Last on, first off.** Put jewellery on as the very last step of getting ready — after moisturiser, perfume, and hairspray — and make it the first thing you remove at home.
- 02 One piece, one space.** Store items separately so metals and stones can't scratch one another in a drawer or pouch.
- 03 Warm water beats every "miracle" cleaner.** Warm water and a drop of mild washing-up liquid is safe for almost all fine jewellery — it's what we use on our own bench.
- 04 If in doubt, take it off.** Chemicals, chlorine, and hard knocks cause more damage than everyday wear ever will.
- 05 See a professional at least once a year.** A worn prong or thinning plating is an easy fix caught early, and a heartbreaking one caught late.

"Care for fine jewellery isn't complicated — it's a handful of small habits, repeated."

Yellow Gold



Warm, timeless, and endlessly versatile — a little regular care keeps yellow gold glowing for generations.

I. How to Clean

Soak in warm water with a few drops of mild washing-up liquid for 10–15 minutes. Loosen residue with a soft-bristled brush, rinse well under warm water, and pat dry with a lint-free cloth. Buff with a polishing cloth for everyday shine.

II. Products to Avoid

Chlorine, bleach, ammonia-based cleaners, and abrasive scourers can pit or weaken gold over time. Avoid home ultrasonic or steam cleaners unless a jeweller has checked the piece first.

III. When to Remove It

Take gold off before swimming, cleaning, gardening, washing up, and applying lotion, perfume, or hairspray. Chemical residue is a leading cause of a dulled finish.

IV. Storage

Store each piece separately in a soft pouch or lined compartment. Gold is comparatively soft, and pieces rubbing together is a common cause of surface scratches.

V. Scratches & Polishing

Fine hairline scratches are natural and buff out easily. Deeper scratches or dents are best restored by a jeweller, who can re-polish without removing excess metal.

VI. Professional Cleaning

An annual professional clean restores shine home care can't reach, and lets us check clasps, prongs, and joints while the piece is on the bench.

"The golden rule: warm water, mild washing-up liquid, a soft brush, and a gentle dry."

10–15

MINUTES TO SOAK

Yearly

PROFESSIONAL CLEAN

Soft

CLOTH ONLY, NO FORCE

Sterling Silver

Our Sterling 925 collection brings a bright finish to everyday jewellery. Gentle cleaning and dry storage help keep each piece looking its best.

I. Cleaning

Use lukewarm water and a little mild washing-up liquid. Clean gently with a soft cloth or soft brush, rinse thoroughly, and dry completely. Ask us first if your piece has a special finish or delicate stones.

II. Understanding Tarnish

Silver naturally tarnishes when exposed to air, moisture and everyday substances. A darker surface does not mean the silver is faulty. Gentle, appropriate care can restore its shine.

III. Gentle Polishing

For plain, uncoated silver, use a silver polishing cloth with light pressure. Avoid toothpaste, abrasive scrubs and harsh dips. For plated finishes or stone-set pieces, ask us which method is suitable.

IV. Chemicals & Chlorine

Remove silver before swimming, hot tubs, cleaning and exercise. Keep it away from bleach and other strong chemicals. Apply perfume, lotions and hairspray before putting jewellery on.

V. Storage

Store each piece fully dry in a separate soft, anti-tarnish pouch or lined compartment. Keep it away from humid bathrooms and direct heat. Separating pieces also helps prevent scratches and tangles.

VI. Professional Maintenance

Bring in pieces with stubborn tarnish, damaged clasps or loose stones. A jeweller can recommend suitable cleaning and check the settings. Have regularly worn pieces inspected at least once a year.

"Silver rewards gentle care: clean softly, dry thoroughly, and store separately."

925 Silver

STERLING SILVER COLLECTION

Keep Dry

DRY FULLY BEFORE STORING

Soft Cloth

GENTLE CARE, NO SCRUBBING

Diamonds



The hardest natural material on earth, diamonds are wonderfully low-maintenance — it's the setting around them that needs the closest attention.

I. Cleaning Safely

Soak in warm water with mild washing-up liquid for 15–20 minutes to loosen the everyday build-up of lotion, soap, and skin oils that dulls sparkle.

II. Soft Toothbrush P Gentle Cleaning

Gently brush around the stone and underneath the setting with a soft-bristled toothbrush, where light needs to pass through for maximum sparkle. Rinse well and dry with a lint-free cloth.

III. Chemicals to Avoid

Chlorine and harsh household chemicals won't harm the diamond itself, but can corrode the metal setting, raising the risk of a stone working loose.

IV. When to Remove Rings

Remove diamond rings before swimming, showering, exercising, cleaning, gardening, and before applying hand cream or perfume, which builds up around the setting.

V. Checking Stone Settings

Every few weeks, gently check with a fingertip that the stone doesn't move. If it feels loose or a prong looks worn, stop wearing the piece and bring it in.

VI. Professional Inspection

Every six to twelve months, our jewellers check every prong under magnification, catch wear early, and give the stone a deep clean for full brilliance.

"A diamond can't be damaged by daily life — but its setting can. Check it as often as you wear it."

15–20

MINUTES TO SOAK

5–12

MONTHS BETWEEN INSPECTIONS

Fingertip

CHECK, NEVER TOOLS

Three-Stone Rings — Where to Clean P Check

Three-stone settings carry more metalwork than a solitaire — here's exactly where to focus when you clean and inspect one at home.



Three-Stone Round Classic

- 1 Centre stone prongs — the hardest-working claws; check for wear every six months.
- 2 Left side-stone prongs — its own set of claws; check independently of the centre.
- 3 Right side-stone prongs — the same again; it's common for one side to loosen before the other.
- 4 Pavé band — clean gently with a soft brush; avoid abrasive cloths on tiny stones.



Marquise P Pear Three-Stone

- 1 Top tip — the most delicate point on an elongated stone; protect it from knocks.
- 2 Bottom tip — equally delicate; avoid pressure or catching it on fabric.
- 3 Left pear-stone prongs — check separately from the centre stone.
- 4 Right pear-stone prongs — the same again on this side.

— Why Three-Stone Settings Need Extra Attention

A solitaire has one stone and one set of prongs to think about. A three-stone ring has three of each — which means three times the opportunity for a claw to catch, wear thin, or need a gentle re-tightening. None of this makes the setting less durable; it simply means a slightly closer eye pays off, especially around the points where the metalwork for each stone meets the shared gallery below.

East-West Solitaires — Where to Clean P Check

A stone set sideways across the finger looks strikingly modern — and wears in a slightly different pattern to an up-and-down solitaire.



Oval East-West Solitaire

- 1 Left claw — a minimalist prong doing extra work; check it a little more often.
- 2 Right claw — the same on this side.
- 3 Top girdle edge — the long edge sits exactly where fingers brush against things; remove for sport and manual tasks.
- 4 Underside gallery — lotion and oils collect here first; brush gently underneath during cleaning.

"The more stones or the more unusual the orientation, the more a setting benefits from checks every six months rather than yearly."

2

CLAWS HOLDING THE WHOLE
STONE

5 Mo.

RECOMMENDED CHECK INTERVAL

Off

FOR SPORT & MANUAL TASKS

— Why East-West Wears Differently

On a traditional up-and-down solitaire, the narrow tips of the stone point toward your knuckle and fingertip — the two areas that take the least surface contact through the day. Turn that same stone sideways, and its longest edges now sit exactly where your fingers brush against bags, steering wheels, and countertops. It's not a flaw in the design — it's simply a style that rewards a slightly closer eye, in exchange for a strikingly modern look.

When Should I Take My Jewellery Off?

A simple rule of thumb: if you wouldn't wear it into a swimming pool or a chemistry lab, it's worth taking off for that activity too.

Situation	Why It Matters
Swimming	Chlorine can damage gold alloys and discolour silver. Remove jewellery before swimming or using a hot tub.
Showering	Soap and shampoo residue builds up in settings, dulling shine and encouraging discolouration.
Bathing	Bath oils, salts, and hot water accelerate wear on plating and settings.
Gym / Exercise	Sweat is acidic and can discolour metal; equipment poses a real risk of scratches or a lost stone.
Gardening	Soil and grit scratch soft metals and work under prongs; gloves and rings don't mix.
Using Chemicals	From paint thinner to hair dye — jewellery off before, back on after.
Creams & Perfume	Lotion and fragrance leave a film that dulls shine and collects in settings — apply first, jewellery after.

"Jewellery off, then live your life — put it back on once the activity, chemical, or cream is done."

Signs It's Time to Visit Us

Between annual check-ups, these signals mean a piece is worth bringing in sooner rather than later — almost all are quick, easy fixes when caught early.

— Warning Signs

- ◆ A stone that moves, rattles, or looks crooked
- ◆ A prong that looks flattened or catches on fabric
- ◆ Silver tarnish that gentle care does not remove
- ◆ A ring that spins more than it used to
- ◆ No professional check in over a year

— Caring for Jewellery While Travelling

Pack pieces separately in a compartmented case rather than loose in a wash bag.

Remove jewellery for security checks, swimming, and spa treatments — pools and sun cream abroad are just as harsh as at home.

Keep valuable pieces with you rather than in checked luggage, and note a description or photo just in case.

Summer

PROTECT SILVER FROM
SWEAT & POOL WATER

Winter

WATCH FOR CREAM & GLOVE
RESIDUE

Yearly

A LOVELY HOLIDAY TRADITION



Let Us Take Care of It

*Bring your jewellery in for a complimentary visual health check —
cleaning, prong inspection, and silver care advice, all in one visit.*

VISIT

In Store, By
Appointment
or Walk-In

CALL

Your Local
Boutique

ASK ABOUT

Annual
Cleaning
Membership

Victoria Diamonds — Fine Jewellery, Cared For